3. Reliable evidence shows that the consensus of opinion among experts is that further studies or clinical trials are necessary to determine its maximum tolerated dose, its toxicity, its safety, its efficacy, or its efficacy as compared with the standard means of treatment or diagnosis.
4. Reliable evidence shows that the healthcare service does not improve health outcome, is not more beneficial as established alternative(s) for the proposed use or patient specific condition or diagnosis, service does not produce improvement outside of the research setting or is otherwise not consistent with generally accepted standards of medical practice in the United States.
5. Reliable evidence shall mean credible scientific evidence published in peer-reviewed medical literature generally recognized by the relevant medical community, nationally recognized evidence-based clinical guidelines and criteria from independent sources, national physician specialty society recommendations, and the views of medical practitioners practicing in relevant clinical areas, and any other relevant factors. Please refer to geha.com/Coverage-Criteria for details on the literature used in medical decision making.

Determination of experimental/investigational status may require review of appropriate government publications such as those of the National Institute of Health, National Cancer Institute, Agency for Healthcare Policy and Research, Food and Drug Administration, National Library of Medicine, the American Hospital Formulary Service, or the United States American Hospital Pharmacopoeia Dispensing Information. We reserve the right to consult expert opinion in determining whether healthcare services are Experimental or Investigational.

Group health coverage Healthcare coverage that a member or covered dependent is eligible for because of employment by, membership in, or connection with, a particular organization or group that provides payment for hospital, medical, dental or other healthcare services or supplies, including extension of any of these benefits through COBRA.

Habilitative Therapy is initiated to address a genetic, congenital, or early acquired disorder resulting in significant deficit of Activities of Daily Living (ADL), fine motor, or gross motor skills. Therapy services are provided to enhance functional status and are focused on developing skills that were never present.

Healthcare professional A physician or other healthcare professional licensed, accredited, or certified to perform specified health services consistent with state law.

Iatrogenic infertility An impairment of fertility by surgery, radiation, chemotherapy, or other medical treatment affecting reproductive organs including gonadotoxic therapies, or ovary or testicle removal for treatment of disease.

In vitro fertilization In vitro fertilization (IVF) is a method of assisted reproduction that involves combining an egg with sperm in a laboratory dish. If the egg fertilizes and begins cell division, the resulting embryo may be transferred into the uterus where it may implant in the uterine lining and further develop, or be cryopreserved for later transfer. A cycle of IVF is defined as stimulation of ovaries, oocyte retrieval, and embryo transfer or preservation.

Infertility Infertility is defined as the inability to conceive pregnancy within a 12-month period for individuals under age 35 (6 months for persons aged 35 or older) through unprotected intercourse or artificial insemination. Infertility may also be established through evidence of medical history and diagnostic testing. Infertility includes the need for medical intervention to conceive pregnancy either as an individual or with a partner, except following voluntary sterilization.